

No hands!

Project Natal is Microsoft's upcoming hands-free peripheral

Budding studios

Activision Blizzard announces the launch of their new Sledgehammer studio in California

Sony DVP-NS728

Offers you the standard fare

Players seem to be going old school lately. At least that's what it seemed like judging by the displays on the ones we got for review this time. All of them featured one of those retro 7 segment LED displays like the ones VHS players of yesteryear used to sport. Surprisingly this juxtaposition of old and new makes for a classy recipe. But that's the only thing that's retro about this player.

It features an HDMI port, however the playback quality is strictly OK. We looked at scenes from some of our test DVDs as well as XviD clips. There's no skipping or motion blur but the colours on DVD video are



less vibrant, with output appearing slightly more grainy than you would like. We used an LG Jazz 42 inch LCD to check upscaling of low quality 700 MB XviD clips to 1080p and it faired quite well. The player's settings interface, as well as the one for browsing USB data is quite cumbersome. It neglects certain expected elements like ease of switching between Disk and USB. To view different types of content you need to go to specific viewing modes like music/

video/photo etc. It does however sport some interesting features such as it's own chapter and title browsing menu (with thumbnails), an audio sync buffer of 100 ms to sync mismatching audio with video, and variable playback speeds of .4x to 1.4x.

A player with similar features from other makes would normally be under the Rs. 4,000 mark. We'd be willing to recommend this product if it were a considerably better product than those though.

Contact

Sony India

Phone: 1800-11-11-88

Email: sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com

Web: www.sony.co.in

Price: Rs. 5,290

Specifications

Media: DVD, CD, VCD, SVCD, CD-R, RW; **Formats:** MP3, DivX, AAC, WMA, JPEG; **DAC:** 12-bit, 108 MHz

RATINGS

Features..... 6
Performance 6
Build quality 6.5
Value for money ... 6.5
Overall 6.5

Contact

Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: +91-22-6709 0828

Email: response

@rptechindia.com

Web: www.alteclansing.com

Price: Rs. 13,999

Specifications

Power: 200W RMS;

Drivers: 3-inch midrange (x2), 1-inch tweeter (x2),

6.5-inch woofer, **Frequency range:** 40 Hz to 20 kHz

RATINGS

Features..... 7.5
Performance 7
Build quality 7
Value for money 5
Overall 6.5

Altec Lansing MX6021

Sporting a new face...

Altec Lansing's older MX5021 was one of the best desktop speakers to hit the market. The new MX6021 model has a design seen on some of the newer models. The woofer is huge and one of the largest you'll come across. The satellites have two drivers – one for the mids and then tweeter. These are suspended on a flat plastic surface.

There is no wireless remote, instead a new fancy wired remote control replaces the one used on the MX5021. It uses a spring dial and two buttons to control the bass and treble. Auxiliary input and headphone out



ports are present on it. It's not accurate at all and we preferred to adjust the volume from the source itself

The speaker is loud, but that's about it. The bass isn't punchy. The mids and extreme high-end frequencies are well pronounced, but the gap between those ranges isn't clear.

The woofer also mixes up bass guitars and voices of certain artists. There is no distortion at high volumes however.

All in all, this is a good performer but nowhere close to the MX5021. The cost should however be much lower. Right now, the model sells for a rather high price tag of Rs. 13,999.